

1 — Reactivity: \$state

STATE MANAGEMENT

Q. How do you declare a variable that automatically updates the DOM when its value changes in Svelte 5?

ANSWER. Normally, JavaScript variables are completely dead: changing a `let` variable does not update your UI. You use the `$state` rune to wrap your initial value, turning it into a live variable that Svelte tracks. Any time that value changes, Svelte instantly updates the DOM for you.

App.svelte

```
<script>
  let count = $state(0);
  let user = $state({ name: 'Nikos' });

  function update() {
    count++;
    user.name = 'Hugo'; // Deeply reactive
  }
</script>
```

DIAGRAM CONCEPT. The Live Feed: `$state` is the news wire desk, and every `{count}` in the markup is a subscriber; one update crosses the wire and every subscriber re-renders.

THE LIVE FEED

THE WIRE • ONE SOURCE

`let count = $state(0)`



`<h1>{count}</h1>`

SUBSCRIBER • RE-RENDERS

`<button>{count}</button>`

SUBSCRIBER • RE-RENDERS

ONE UPDATE • EVERY SUBSCRIBER RE-RENDERS

❶ **Summary.** A plain `let` is a dead wire: change it and the page never hears about it. `$state` makes the wire live, so every change is delivered to the screen

and you never touch the DOM by hand again.